

1. iNaturalist Sightings

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-01T19:35:41+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/1/inat-sightings/#atom-everything>

Tool: iNaturalist Sightings I wanted to see my iNaturalist observations - across two separate accounts - grouped by when they occurred. I'm camping this weekend so I built this entirely on my phone using Claude Code for web. I started by building an inaturalist-clumper Python CLI for fetching and "clumping" observations - by default clumps use observations within 2 hours and 5km of each other. Then I setup `simonw/inaturalist-clumps` as a Git scraping repository to run that tool and record the result to `clumps.json`. That JSON file is hosted on GitHub, which means it can be fetched by JavaScript using CORS. Finally I ran this prompt against my `simonw/tools` repo: Build `inat-sightings.html` - an app that does a `fetch()` against <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/simonw/inaturalist-clumps/refs/heads/main/clumps.json> and then displays all of the observations on one page using the <https://static.inaturalist.org/photos/538073008/small.jpg> small.jpg URLs for the thumbnails - with `loading=lazy` - but when a thumbnail is clicked showing the large.jpg in an HTML modal. Both small and large should include the common species names if available Tags: tools , claude-code , inaturalist , generative-ai...

2. We need RSS for sharing abundant vibe-coded apps

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-04-30T18:38:48+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Apr/30/rss-vibe-coded-apps/#atom-everything>

We need RSS for sharing abundant vibe-coded apps Matt Webb: I would love an RSS web feed for all those various tools and apps pages, each item with an ?Install? button. (But install to where?) The lesson here is that when vibe-coding accelerates app development, apps become more personal, more situated, and more frequent. Shipping a tool or a micro-app is less like launching a website and more like posting on a blog. This inspired me to have Claude add an Atom feed (and icon) to my `/elsewhere/tools/` page, which itself is populated by content from my `tools.simonwillison.net` site. Tags: atom , matt-webb , rss , ai , vibe-coding

3. IIm 0.32a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-04-29T18:57:47+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Apr/29/IIm-2/#atom-everything>

Release: IIm 0.32a0 See the annotated release notes . Tags: IIm

4. SBC Clusters are a terrible value, but they're fun anyway

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 09:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/deskpi-super4c-sbc-cluster/>

Pictured above is the new DeskPi Super4C installed in an 8U mini rack. The Super4C is a 4-node Raspberry Pi CM5 cluster board that solves two pain points I had with the older Super6C . I was testing this board around the same time I helped kick off the SBCC 2026 , the Single Board Cluster Competition for students. A dozen or so university teams squared off to run the best mini HPC cluster with a budget of \$6,000, and a couple days to benchmark six HPC workloads .

5. More on Apple?s Logically Elegant Tariff Refund Puzzle Solution

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-02T01:06:31Z

Link: <https://daringfireball.net/linked/2026/05/01/tim-cooks-clever-solution-to-the-tariff-refund-puzzle>

Regarding my earlier post about the cleverness of Tim Cook?s solution to Apple?s dilemma regarding how to apply for, and accept, a potential tariff refund check without drawing the ire of Donald ? Tariff Is My Favorite Word ? Trump, at least one reader asked why Tim Cook committing to spending the refund check on ?U.S. innovation and advanced manufacturing? doesn?t mean that Apple would ? if they get a tariff refund ? be spending more than they had previously

committed to. Cook even said yesterday , ?These would be new investments and would be in addition to our prior commitments in the U.S.? But there?s never been any precise accounting for these commitments. Apple committed to spend ?more than \$500 billion?. ?More than \$500 billion? plus their tariff refund check would still be ?more than \$500 billion?. Here?s what I wrote when Apple first made this current commitment in February 2025, just weeks after Trump?s second term started : Apple announced a similar plan four years ago ? \$430 billion and 20,000 jobs. In the announcement of that 2021 plan, Apple said , ?Over the past three years, Apple?s contributions in the US have significantly outpaced the company?s original five-year...

6. Meta Solved Their Problem With Kenyan Contractors Seeing Footage of AI Glasses Wearers on the Toilet

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-01T21:00:36Z

Link: <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c5y7yvyg0w6o>

Remember the appalling but utterly-unsurprising story two months ago where a team of investigative reporters in Sweden uncovered a company in Kenya contracted by Meta to review video content captured by Meta?s ?smart? glasses? They spoke to some of the workers , who told tales of reviewing footage of Meta glasses users getting undressed, having sex, and taking dumps. This is a rather seedy job, and a big surprise to most of the people wearing Meta?s AI glasses, who are under the impression that ?AI? does not involve human beings in Kenya seeing what their glasses capture. Well, Meta has fixed the problem. Chris Vallance reports for BBC News : Meta is under pressure to explain why it cancelled a major contract with a company it was using to train AI, shortly after some of its Kenya-based workers alleged they had to view graphic content captured by Meta smart glasses. In February, workers at the company, Sama, told two Swedish newspapers they had witnessed glasses users going to the toilet, and having sex . Less than two months later, Meta ended its contract with Sama, which Sama said would result in 1,108 workers being made redundant. Meta says it?s because Sama did not meet its st...

7. Tim Cook?s Clever Solution to the Tariff Refund Puzzle

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-01T20:30:47Z

Link: <https://sixcolors.com/post/2026/04/apple-results-analysis-net-net-over-the-moon/>

One more from Jason Snell, from his analysis of Apple?s quarterly results: During a complicated question from J.P. Morgan analyst Samik Chatterjee about product margins, Parekh unusually half-answered the question and then stopped and ?turned it over to Tim? so that Cook could read an obviously prepared statement about tariffs, which included this bit: In terms of applying for a refund of tariffs paid, we?re following the established processes, and we plan to reinvest any amount we receive back into U.S. innovation and advanced manufacturing. These would be new investments and would be in addition to our prior commitments in the U.S. This is the sort of politics Cook will continue to be plying from the boardroom. Sure, Apple?s going to try to get its tariff money back. But it?s going to do so using the perfectly normal and established process, and if it does get billions back from the U.S. government, it double-promises to reinvest that money in the United States, above and beyond its already stated commitments. Trump Administration, take note. The kind of logic puzzles I enjoy most are ones where, when the puzzle is posed, there?s no obvious solution. But once you see the solutio...

8. Disable Auto-Update

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 23:30:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/disable-auto-update?src=feed>

How is it possible that a feature I use every day, in an app I rely on daily, entirely offline, just disappeared from my phone? I use a fitness app. My metrics, such as steps, workout routines, heart rate, are collected from a wearable device like a smartwatch and sent to the app via Bluetooth. No third-party servers are involved in that transaction. The data lives on the phone. It costs the developer nothing to maintain, because there?s nothing to maintain on their end. Then the app updates, just once, and that data is no longer accessible. Not because it was deleted or corrupted. Because the developer decided you now need to create an account on

their servers to access information that already exists on your own device. That's why I have auto-update disabled on every device I own. Some of the apps on my phone are older than my children. You couldn't download them today even if you wanted to. The developer no longer offers that version. One of my apps is a single screen that displays information based on GPS data and compass orientation. I downloaded it in 2014. I've switched phones twice since then, and each time I've made sure to carry that app with me. I didn't keep it out of...

9. Developing a cross-process reader/writer lock with limited readers, part 4: Abandonment

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260501-00/?p=112291>

Recovering from death of the owner. The post Developing a cross-process reader/writer lock with limited readers, part 4: Abandonment appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Learning my lesson that Python virtual environments aren't always movable

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-01T02:54:21Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/python/VenvsNotEntirelyMovable>

I've said before that Python virtual environments can be moved around . Well, technically that entry said 'usually', but in practice I don't remember the limitations I mentioned in that entry. And that is how a while back I renamed the top level directory of a Django virtual environment that I'd also installed the Python LSP server into , and then yesterday I was rather puzzled when I tried some Django development and GNU Emacs gave me a weird error and didn't start my LSP environment. (Fortunately what I was really doing was seeing how my new Corfu based lsp-mode completion would behave with some Python code.) The issue is simple: every (Python) program installed into your venv 's bin/ directory starts with ' `#!/path/to/venv/bin/python3` ', including programs like pylsp , the Python LSP server . They have to do this because they need to run the venv's Python, but that means that they're locked to the original filesystem location of the venv. If you move the venv, either there will be no 'python3' at that path for them to run or worse, you'll be pointing into and using a different venv. Programs outside the venv aren't normally affected, because they're directly using the venv's bi...

11. NHS Goes To War Against Open Source

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 11:44:04 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/nhs-goes-to-war-against-open-source/>

The NHS is preparing to close nearly all of its Open Source repositories. Throughout my time working for the UK Government - in GDS, NHSX, iAI, and others - I championed Open Source. I spoke to dozens of departments about it, wrote guidance still in use today, and briefed Ministers on why it was so important. That's why I'm beyond disappointed at recent moves from NHS England to backtrack on?

12. Offline command line translation with TranslateGemma + Ollama

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/offline-cli-translation-with-translategemma-and-ollama/>

I wrote a simple script that translates text at the command line, completely offline. Here's an example of how it works on my computer: `echo '¿Cómo estás?' | translate # => How are you?` It combines a few tools: TranslateGemma , a special-purpose language model for translation Ollama , a tool for running language models locally Efficient Language Detector , a library that detects the language for a piece of text Here's the pseudocode of how it works: `source = read_stdin() # Uses Efficient Language Detector source_language = detect_language(source) # Uses JavaScript's 'navigator.language' target_language = get_system_language() # Uses Ollama + TranslateGemma return translate(source, source_language, target_language)` I built this because I couldn't find anyone else who had done it. It's written in Deno for my specific needs?for example, it only translates text into your system's language?but could easily be adapted if you need something else. I like that I can do offline, private, automatic translation. It's imperfect, but useful for me! Here's the source code.

13. Patching and forking in package managers

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-01T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/01/patching-and-forking-in-package-managers.html>

When a dependency has a known vulnerability and no maintainer to release a fix, you have to fix it yourself. Clone the source, apply the patch, get the patched version back into your dependency tree. The volume of reported CVEs is going to rise, and many will land in packages where nobody is around to cut a release. System package managers handled this a long time ago. Debian's `debian/patches/` with quilt and DEP-3 headers, RPM's `Patch0:` directives in spec files, Gentoo's `/etc/portage/patches/`, Nix's patches attribute in derivations, Homebrew's patch do ... end blocks in formulae. Distribution maintainers are expected to carry deltas against upstream, and the tooling is designed around that assumption. Language package managers were designed around a different assumption: the registry version is authoritative, the user picks which version they want, and nobody modifies what's inside. When upstream can't or won't release a fix, users hit tooling that wasn't built for the situation they're in. What you need depends on the situation. Redirecting a dependency to a fork you control is the most common workaround. Overriding what the resolver picks for a transitive dependency buried in y...

14. AI will create jobs

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-05-01T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io//blog/jekyll/update/2026/05/01/ai-will-create-jobs.html>

It's nice to see Jensen talk about this, and it's super obvious when you think about it. AI and immigration are fundamentally the same. There's new people showing up, and hopefully everyone understands how and why immigration creates jobs. Wants are effectively unlimited. It's classic Jevons paradox that if we make something more efficient, we end up using more of it. Or a cool aphorism I learned at Facebook, if you make the site 10% faster, people spend 5% more total time on it. Now, just like you get the wahh wahh crying people about how immigration lowers wages for native born Americans and we gotta keep the hard working immigrants out because you have some right to be lazy because of where you were born or something, you'll get this about AI. AI will outcompete some humans at some jobs. But protectionism is for losers. The important thing is that the overall pie grows, and inequality stays somewhat in check, not by redistribution but by design. There will be more to do than ever before.

15. Touch Typing Number Keys

Source: Susam Pal | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://susam.net/touch-typing-number-keys.html>

I learnt touch typing about two decades ago when I was still at university. Although I took some typewriter lessons as a child, those lessons did not stick with me. It was at university, when I found a Java applet-based touch typing tutor on the web, that I really learnt to touch type. Since then, touch typing has been an important part of my computing life. I've sometimes read arguments on the web downplaying touch typing as a skill, with claims like 'typing isn't the bottleneck, thinking is'. While that may be true, I still consider touch typing a useful skill, since it makes writing documents, code and email feel much more fluid and pleasant. It's like playing a musical instrument with the correct technique, rather than simply getting by without it. One feels smooth and expressive and the other feels raw and laboured. Later in life, I also wrote a tool named QuickQWERTY so that I could share the joy of touch typing with my friends. The tool teaches typing only with the QWERTY layout. I wrote it at a time when I did not know much about the computing world, so I was not even aware that other keyboard layouts existed. As a result, only QWERTY is supported. The tool is free and open...

16. Apr '26 Notes

Source: Susam Pal | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://susam.net/26d.html>

This is my fourth set of monthly notes for this year where I write down interesting facts and ideas I have explored during my spare time. There were three things in particular that occupied

my leisure time this month. First, I managed to learn the proof of Tutte's famous theorem that any (s, t) -arc-transitive finite cubic graph must satisfy $|E| \leq 5|V|$. I learnt the proof from Norman Biggs's book Algebraic Graph Theory . The original proof appears in Tutte's 1947 paper 'A family of cubical graphs' (DOI). Biggs's presentation differs considerably from Tutte's original argument and relies heavily on the properties of stabiliser sequences of arcs. I should say that Biggs's proof, while complete, is extremely condensed. The proof reads more like a high-level outline that moves rapidly from one main result to the next without sufficiently explaining the intermediate steps. As a result, it took considerable effort to work out the proofs of the intermediate results. Biggs presents the proof in roughly nine pages spread across two chapters. However, when I worked through it in full detail while ensuring that every step is justified, my notes eventually grew to around 18 pages of A4 p...

17. The Mystery of Rennes-le-Château, Part 5: The Man Behind the Curtain

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 15:46:03 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/05/the-mystery-of-rennes-le-chateau-part-5-the-man-behind-the-curtain/>

This series of articles chronicles the history, both real and pseudo, behind Gabriel Knight 3: Blood of the Sacred, Blood of the Damned. It is possible to trace the Plantard family tree a fair ways back without relying on the Lobineau dossier, but not as far back as the time when the Merovingian kings ruled [?]

18. Hire Me - semi-popular science writing

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 09 Mar 2021 11:25:34 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/hire-me-semi-popular-science/>

In short, if you need engaging in-depth articles on your scientific project, your research breakthrough or the grand new technical/space/molecular/medical thing you are building, you can hire me! (Semi-)Popular science writing I do a lot of what I call (Semi-)popular science writing?. My recent article dissecting the BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 vaccine has racked up over 1.5 million views (so far), and it has done the rounds of the pharmaceutical world where it got favourable reviews.

19. The CureVac Vaccine, and a brief tour through some of the wonders of nature

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 08 Mar 2021 18:22:24 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/curevac-vaccine-and-wonders-of-biology/>

In previous posts I described how the two currently approved mRNA vaccines both use modified nucleosides to enhance their efficiency. Meanwhile, a company called CureVac has created an mRNA vaccine that uses regular, unmodified, RNA. It is currently being tested in large scale trials. In this post I explain what the challenges are with this plain RNA approach, and we reverse engineer quite closely what CureVac has done with regular RNA to (hopefully) deliver an effective vaccine.

20. Stimulating Innovation with Money

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 07 Mar 2021 18:51:43 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/stimulating-innovation/>

This article is part of a series on (European) innovation and capabilities. Periodically I read about governments or institutions wanting to stimulate innovation, often to achieve a certain (worthy) goal. Frequently, the far larger amounts of money that other countries or continents are spending on innovation are then bandied about as justification. And I die a little inside every time that happens. Money and innovation have a very intricate relation.